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Summarize the 1906 San Francisco Earthquake. What factors shaped the current landscape?

The 1906 **San Francisco earthquake** was one of the most devastating natural disasters in U.S. history. It struck on **April 18, 1906**, with an estimated magnitude of **7.9**, along the **San Andreas Fault**. The earthquake caused widespread structural damage, but the subsequent fires—ignited by ruptured gas lines—were even more destructive, destroying about **28,000 buildings** and leaving **over 200,000 people homeless**. Official death estimates ranged from **3,000 to 6,000**, though the exact number is uncertain.

Several factors shaped the city's current landscape:

1. **Urban Reconstruction** – After the disaster, San Francisco underwent a massive rebuilding effort. The city implemented modern building codes and reinforced construction practices, many of which still influence its architecture today.
2. **Landfill and Terrain Changes** – Large areas of the waterfront and parts of the city were reconstructed on landfill, altering the natural shoreline and creating new urban districts such as the **Embarcadero**.
3. **Infrastructure Modernization** – Streets, water systems, and cable car lines were rebuilt and expanded, laying the foundation for the city's present-day transit and utility networks.
4. **Population Shifts** – Many displaced residents relocated, influencing neighborhood demographics and encouraging suburban development in surrounding areas.
5. **Earthquake Awareness and Preparedness** – The disaster shaped California's long-term seismic planning, influencing zoning laws, emergency preparedness, and the design of earthquake-resistant buildings statewide.

In short, the 1906 earthquake not only reshaped San Francisco physically but also transformed its urban planning, architecture, and social fabric—effects still visible in the city's layout and infrastructure today.

If you want, I can also make a **visual map showing the pre- and post-earthquake changes** in San Francisco's landscape. It's quite striking.

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